ARIEN BARLEY

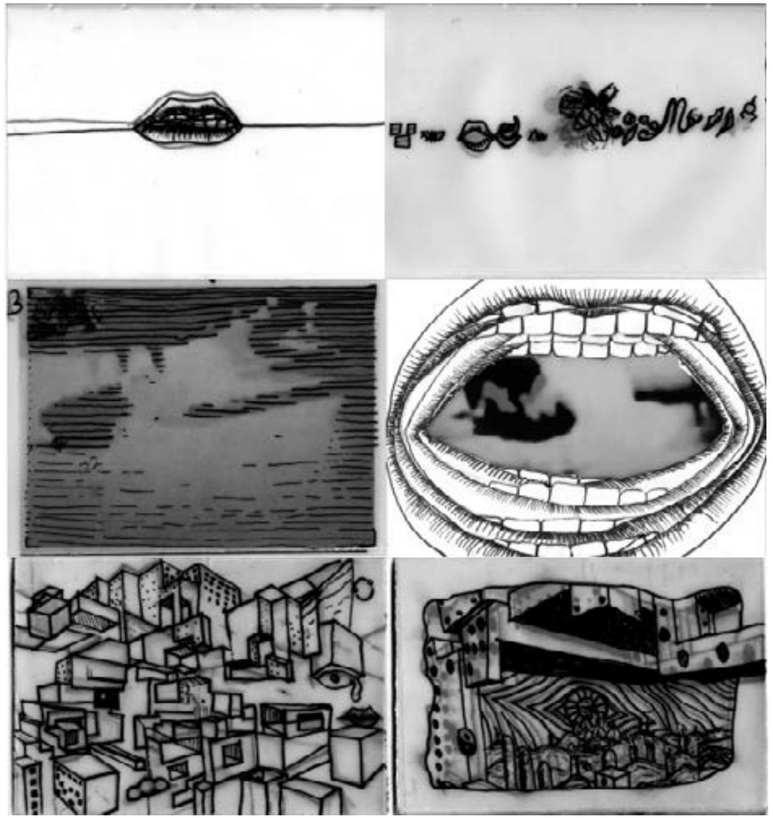
PORTFOLIO 2022

THREE VIEWS OF TIME

FINELINER ANIMATION (2019)

‘Three views of time’ an triptych consisting of three looping animations. Exploring the three different ways we perceive time: across years and generations as stories and characters; through days and weeks as a stream of memories, and from moment to moment within the mind.
The animations express my personal experience of the three states through symbolism, representation and free association.

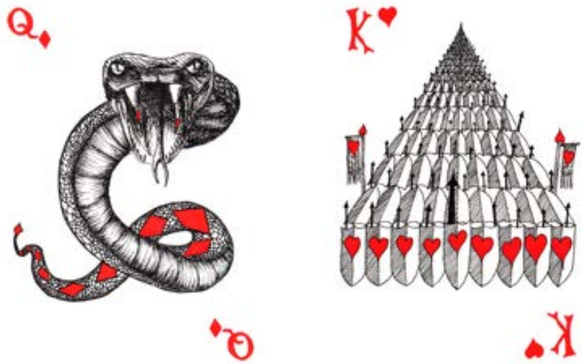
Find the full videos here:
https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLRkUlb9ec-g0eK-oOR7BsvwIKNfeztwLkx



THE FIRST CARDS

HAND DRAWN PLAYING CARDS (2016)

The series was created as a personal project, in choosing the images I was focussed on developing my personal style and skill with representation, as well as considering associations with the suit symbols and picture cards.



TAPESTRY VISUALIZER

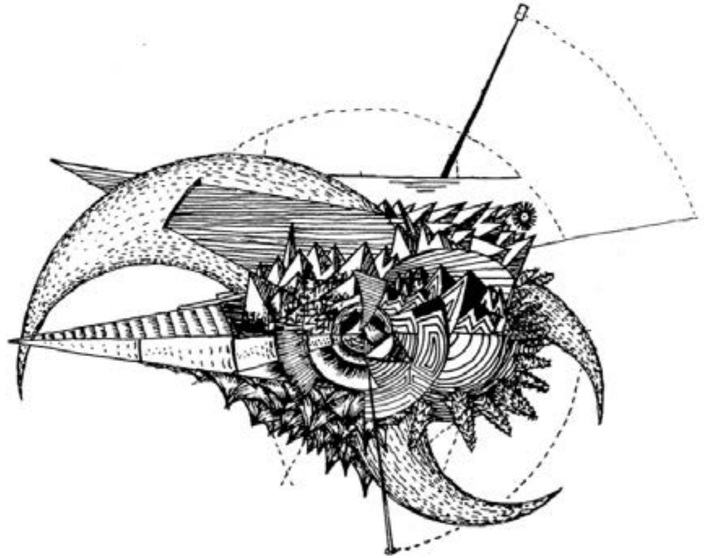
DIGITAL ANIMATION (2020)

In this project I took a few days to animate a piece of my artwork to a friends music. I programmed parts to react to different audio tracks as well as placing sections of animation in time to the music

Find the full video here:

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wLZRsDJSx-0

Or by searching YouTube for ‘Arien Barley Tapestry’



SKETCHBOOK WORK
(2015-PRESENT)

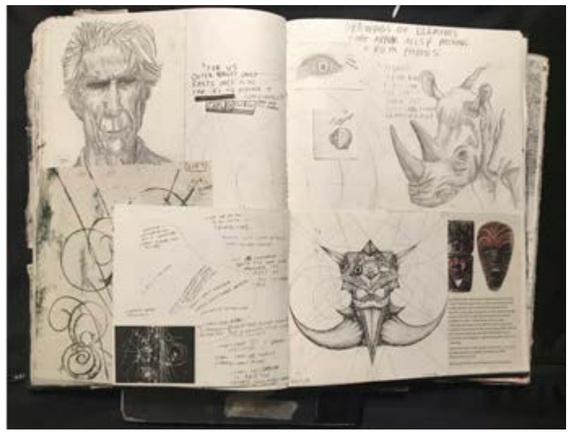
Pages from 14 of the 20 sketchbooks I have carried everywhere for the last 7 years (pictured below, excluding those which were lost).
Throughout these sketchbooks I have explored all the major themes of my more formal art projects as well as practicing my observational drawing. Most notably what I refer to as a brain portrait, letting free association and instinct move the pen to create something spontanious and honest.

RESEARCH BOOKS
SELECTED PAGES (2017-18)

Top left: A page from an A Level research book exploring the relationship between mind, art and the world through distorting an image by continually drawing the previous drawing.

Bottom left: A page from an A Level research book practising realism (top right and left - pencil on paper) and exploring synergies between maths, physics and tribal artwork (bottom right - pen and ink).

Below: A page from an A Level research book combining psychedelia and semi-realism.

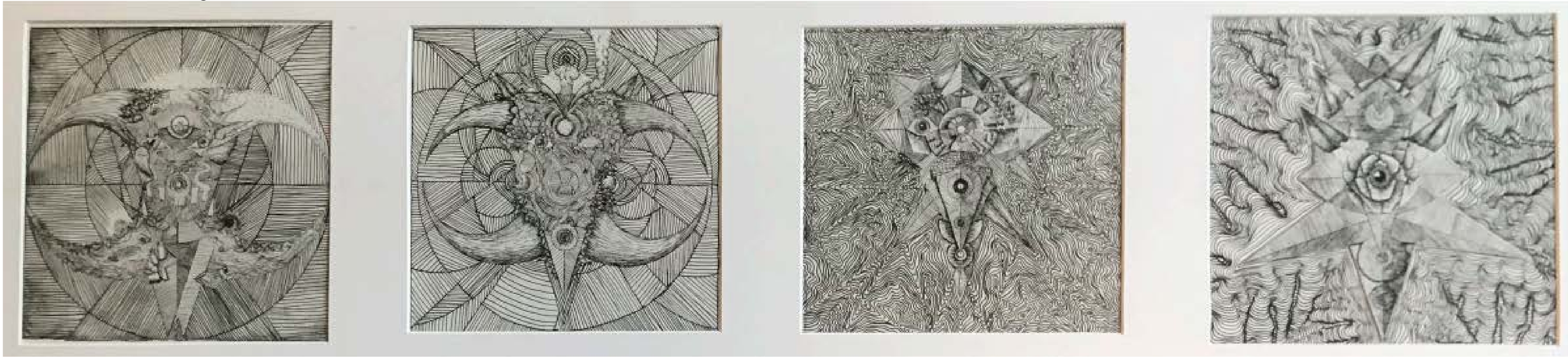


UNTITLED

ETCHING PRINTS WITH PEN AND INK BACKGROUNDS

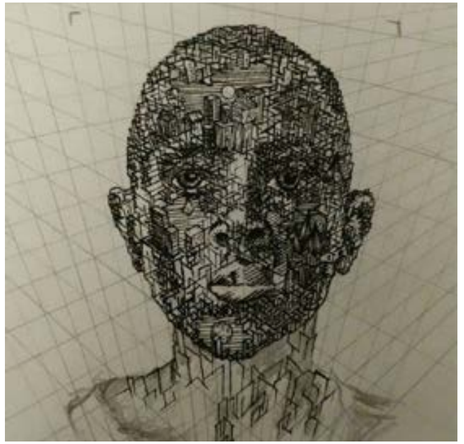
(2018)

One of the final pieces from an A-Level project exploring the synergy between art and maths. The project is situated in a view of art and the world broken down into order and chaos. Drawing from taoism and jungian psychology, the piece focuses on the balance of chaos and order and its importance in all aspects of human life from our perception of beauty to how we navigate the world. These were the culmination of a period in my life where I was seeking balance.



THE HUMAN FORM

SELECTED WORKS
(2019-2022)



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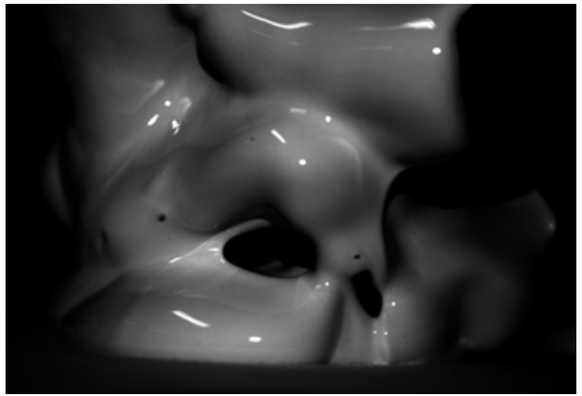
CLAY AND PAINT SCULPTURE
PHOTOGRAPHY
(2019)

An abstract experimental work in light and shadow. Photography was used to draw imagery and emergent meaning from entirely abstract sculptures.



PAPER CUTS

Paper, Light, Photography
(2019)

Drawing from the surreallist movement, this series of paper sculptures were designed to explore chiaroscuro in three dimensional space, as well as developing a sense of mystery and place.

REPRESENTING EMOTION

SELECTED WORKS
(2020-2021)

A theme running through my more recent work has been to try to represent emotional states and events through simple forms and texture. Each captures the sense of a moment of intense feeling for me.

Above right: Dementia (charcoal and texture rubbings)

Bottom left: Sex without Love (charcoal, pen and watercolour)

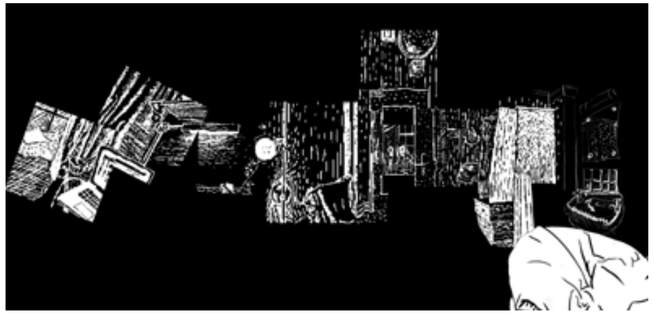
Bottom right: Shipping container, Den Haag (pen and ink)

DIGITAL ART

SELECTED WORKS
(2020-2021)

Below: View of my room, was created during a lockdown a series of low resolution drawings of small secions of my room to represent the claustraphobia and isolation of the experience. Disjointedly positioned as they would fall in the the room as it is, they foom a broken picture of the cell.

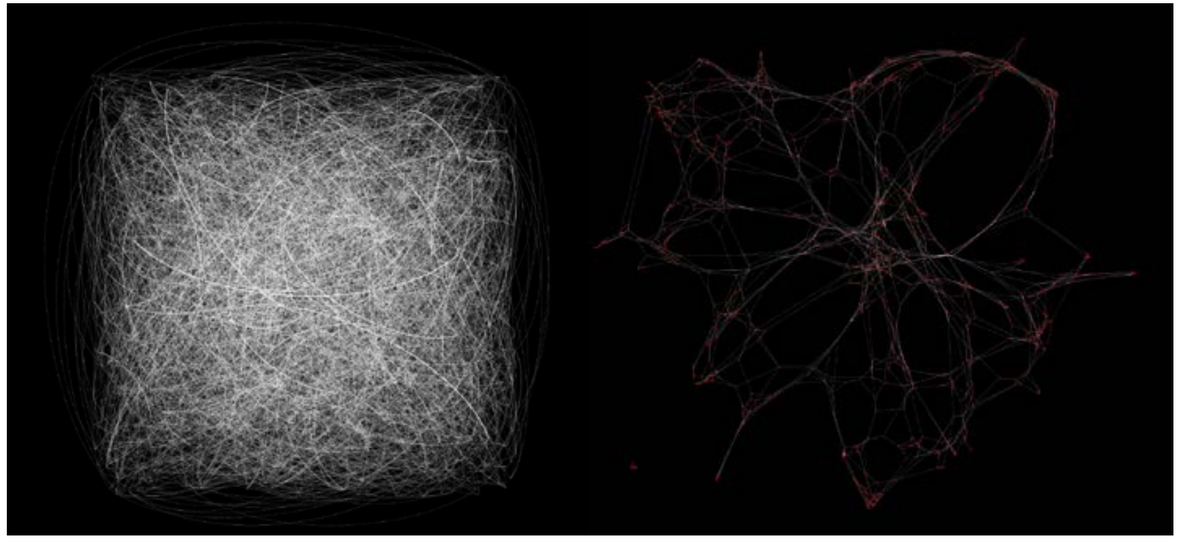
Left: Inversions, limiting myself to only using the invert and polygonal lasso tool in photoshop and drawing from the paper cut series, creating these works was a meditative exploration of the interaction between randomness and intention.



DATA AS A MEDIUM

SELECTED WORKS
(2021-2022)

Examples from a series of visualisations I made exploring the use of data as a raw material for artwork, an idea which I hope to pursue further. These explore the beauty inherent in small-world networks.
Left: Athens (transport network data, python, gephi)
Right: Adelaide (transport network data, python, gephi)



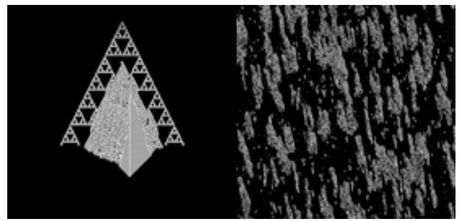
DIGITAL ANIMATION
SELECTED WORKS
(2019-2021)

Top right: Stream, a stream of consciousness animation created for an art module at the Slade. An exercise in the type of free drawing they promoted and a personal expression. The animation can be veiwed here:
https://youtu.be/aJo8TKWzfBs

Middle right: Game of Generating, a demo from a program I wrote which contains many variations on the game of life and the ability to switch between them. I am fascinated by the emergent patterns and properties of sets of simple rules like this and other agent based models. The demo can be viewed here:
https://youtu.be/uCg7FpgdZzU

Bottom right: Red Dance, a work created over the lockdown based on a video of me dancing. The full animation can be found here:
https://youtu.be/apJTGez94hM

Below: Romio and Juliet. After an exercise in drawingthe movement of dancers real-time, I was inspired to capture the movment with the simplicity of the fast, expressive strokes which drawing at that speed required. Here is a link to the resulting animation:
https://youtu.be/UZREmIldXRY



CHARCOAL ANIMATION
SELECTED WORKS
(2020-ONGOING)

Above left is a stream of consciousness animation experimenting with charcoal as a medium, drawing heavily on William Kentridge for inspiration. The work explores drawing as a temporal medium, showing the process of images emerging from one another, and their temporary nature.

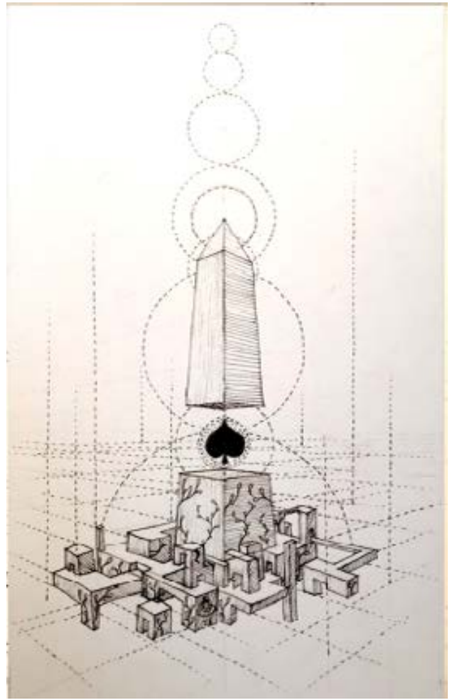
Below left is a collaborative work in progress with Felix J. Mcclafferty at the Royal academy of art Den Haag. The piece is a study in the interaction of artists using the same medium, and the development of a form through the drawing-seeing-drawing feedback loop, as well as improvised narrative in animation.

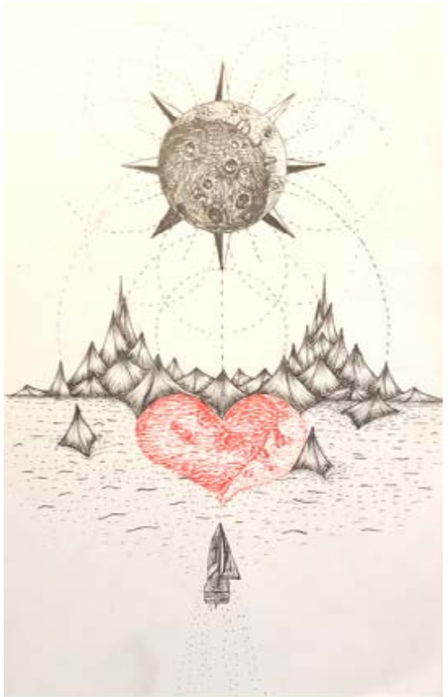
THE SECOND CARDS

HAND DRAWN PLAYING CARDS (2021-ONGOING)

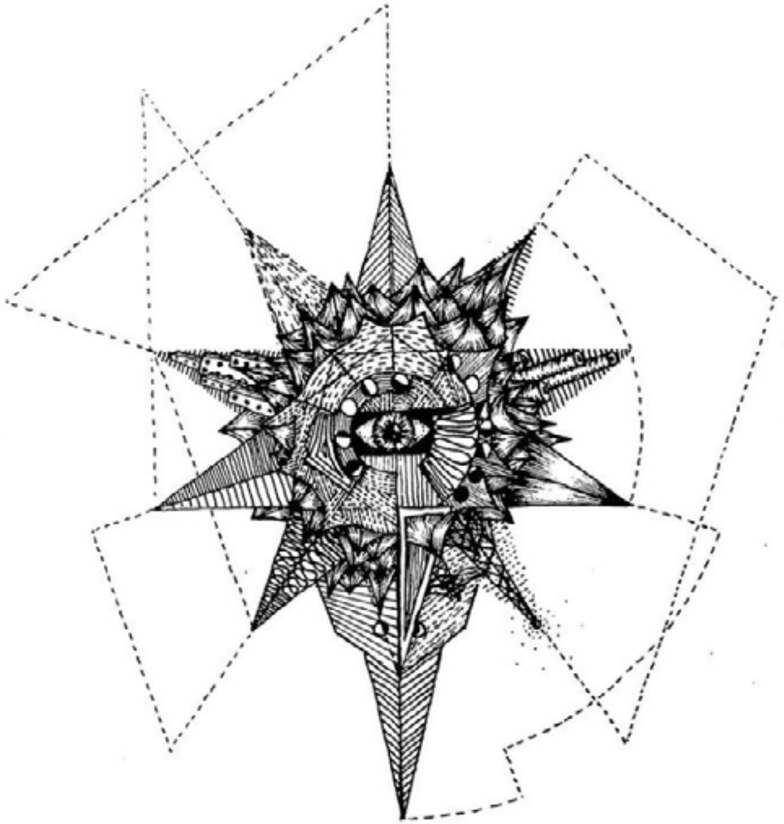
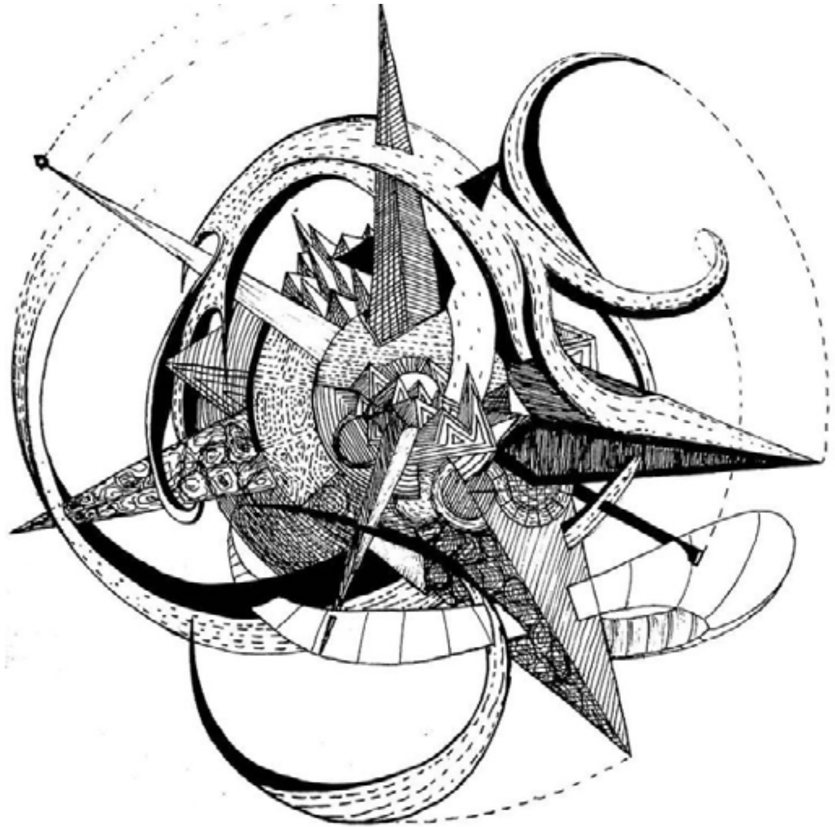
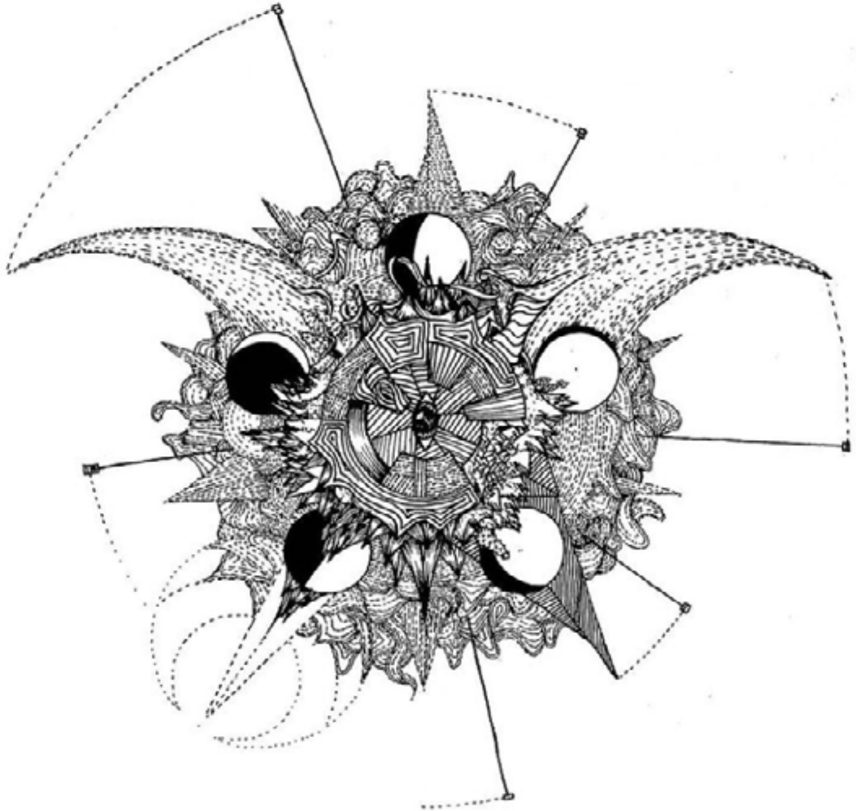
Some concept pieces and drafts for a second deck of cards. Created with reference to tarot, geometry and psychology, they are experiments in how imagery can be created to be perceived as meaningful, and beautiful, by incorporating structure, archetypal themes and pattern.

The cards function as a grounding for development within my art practice. Returning to this format allows me to draw a direct line of growth within my work.





GEOMETRIC SERIES

FINELINER DRAWINGS (2018-ONGOING)

A series exploring mathematical beauty in art. These works are examples of a methodology which developed through the small sketchbook work, A-Level art, and study of jungian psychology and philosophy. It has remained a part of my practice since. Conceptually, the technique is about chaos-order balance in the mind and the art. Practically, it begins with laying out a geometric foundation, often based on the golden ratio, followed by freehand drawing, informed but not controlled by the geometry. This technique developed around a time when I was bringing order back into my life. The increasing structure of the drawings as the technique became more formal and geometric reflected my own increasing organisation.